

Support Escalation Guide

Internal Knowledge Base - Fictional Training Material

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Training notice: This is fictional material created for teaching retrieval-augmented generation.

1. Purpose

- This guide defines when a frontline support agent may resolve a case and when the case must be passed to a specialist queue, team leader or emergency service.
- Escalation protects customers, couriers and AsterLane. It is not an admission of fault.

2. Immediate safety escalation

- Where there is an immediate threat to life, serious injury, fire, violence or an active road incident, advise the person to contact the appropriate emergency service first.
- After immediate safety action, create a Priority 1 incident and notify the Duty Operations Manager.
- Do not ask a person in danger to continue gathering evidence or remain at the scene.

3. Courier or customer threats

- Threats, stalking, harassment, discriminatory abuse or credible intimidation must be escalated to the Safety Response queue.
- Support should capture the order reference, time, location, people involved and a factual description of what was reported.
- Do not share the home address, telephone number or other personal information of one party with the other.
- Do not advise a courier to return to a location where they feel unsafe.

4. Suspected fraud and repeated claims

- Repeated missing-delivery claims, altered photographs, conflicting GPS data, unusual refund activity or suspected account misuse must be referred to Risk Review.
- Frontline agents may place the case on hold but must not tell the customer that they are suspected of fraud.
- Do not block an account, cancel a courier contract or decline a claim solely because an automated risk indicator is present. A trained reviewer must make the decision.
- Where a legitimate customer may be at immediate financial risk, such as an unauthorised payment, follow the account-security process as well as Risk Review.

5. Account security

- Reports of account takeover, an unrecognised login, changed contact details or an unauthorised order must be escalated to Account Security.
- The agent should verify the customer using the approved identity-check process. Do not request a full password, full payment-card number or one-time passcode.
- Where access is still available, advise the customer to change their password and review saved addresses and payment methods.
- Refund decisions for unauthorised transactions are made after the Account Security review.

6. Privacy and data incidents

- A delivery made to the wrong person, an order label exposing another customer's details, or personal information sent to the wrong recipient must be escalated to the Privacy Incident queue.
- The agent should record what information was exposed, to whom, for how long and whether the information has been recovered or deleted.
- Do not ask a customer to forward another person's full personal details through an unsecured channel.
- Privacy incidents must be logged even when the parcel is recovered.

7. Restricted items, medication and contamination

- Any report involving unsafe alcohol delivery, failed age verification, controlled or prescription medication, contamination, allergic reaction or suspected illegal goods must be escalated.
- If a person reports a medical emergency, advise them to contact emergency services.
- Frontline agents must not provide medical advice or make statements about whether a product is safe to consume.

8. Refund and compensation approval

- Frontline customer-support agents may approve eligible refunds up to £75 per order and goodwill credit up to £15.
- Amounts above these limits, multiple refunds on one order, or exceptions to published policy require team-leader approval.
- Courier-payment disputes, including waiting-time and toll reimbursement, must be routed to Courier Payment Review rather than Customer Refunds.

9. When not to escalate

- A routine late delivery that meets the published refund criteria may be resolved by frontline support.
- A straightforward missing-item claim with consistent evidence and a value within the agent's approval limit may be resolved without specialist review.
- A customer asking for the status of an already-open case does not require a new escalation unless new safety, fraud, privacy or account-security information is reported.

10. Required escalation record

- Every escalated case must include the order reference, customer or courier account identifier, issue category, concise factual summary, relevant timestamps, evidence already reviewed and the action requested.
- Use neutral language. Distinguish what is known from what has been alleged.
- Do not copy unnecessary personal information into free-text notes.

11. Knowledge gaps

- If no current policy covers the situation, the agent must not invent a rule or rely on an outdated document.
- Route the case to a team leader with the label 'Policy clarification required' and record the unanswered question.